

Intersection of 2 Lines

1. Find the vector equation of a line passing through $(3,0,2)$ and:

a) perpendicular to both $l_1 : (x,y,z) = (1,2,3) + k(4,-1,2)$

$l_2 : (x,y,z) = (2,-1,4) + m(1,0,-3)$

Method 1

Cross Product

$$\begin{array}{cccccc} 4 & -1 & 2 & 4 & -1 & 2 \\ 1 & 0 & -3 & 1 & 0 & -3 \end{array}$$

$$= [3, 14, 1]$$

$$\therefore v \in: \vec{r} = [3, 0, 2] + t[3, 14, 1], \\ t \in \mathbb{R}$$

Method 2

Let $[a, b, c]$ be the direction vector for the line $\perp$ to l_1 and l_2 .

$$[a, b, c] \cdot [4, -1, 2] = 0$$

$$\boxed{4a - b + 2c = 0} \quad (1)$$

$$[a, b, c] \cdot [1, 0, -3] = 0$$

$$\boxed{a - 3c = 0} \quad (2)$$

Sub (2) into (1)

$$4(3c) - b + 2c = 0$$

$$12c - b + 2c = 0$$

$$b = 14c$$

$$\text{Let } c = 1, \Rightarrow a = 3, b = 14$$

$$\therefore \vec{r} = [3, 0, 2] + t[3, 14, 1], \\ t \in \mathbb{R}$$

b) parallel to the line $(x,y,z) = (-2,6,7) + t(-2,1,3)$

$$\vec{r} = [3, 0, 2] + t[-2, 1, 3], \quad t \in \mathbb{R}$$

2. Find three points on the line $(x, y, z) = (-5, 3, 7) + s(2, -1, 4)$

$$\text{Let } s=0 \Rightarrow (-5, 3, 7)$$

$$\text{Let } s=1 \Rightarrow (-3, 2, 11)$$

$$\text{Let } s=2 \Rightarrow (-1, 1, 15)$$

3. Are $\frac{x-4}{2} = y-6 = z-5$ and $(x, y, z) = (6, 8, 7) + k(-4, -2, -2)$ the same line?

$$\vec{d}_1 = [2, 1, 1] ; \vec{d}_2 = [-4, -2, -2]$$

$$\therefore \vec{d}_2 = -2\vec{d}_1 \Rightarrow \text{the lines are parallel.}$$

$$\text{Find } k: (4, 6, 5) = (6, 8, 7) + k(-4, -2, -2)$$

$$4 = 6 - 4k \rightarrow k = \frac{1}{2}$$

$$6 = 8 - 2k \rightarrow k = 1$$

$$5 = 7 - 2k \rightarrow k = 1$$

Since k values are not the same, the lines are not the same (coincident).